

The Social Network

Check out the new hollywood blockbuster to get a spiced up version of the founding of Facebook

Before social networking

Before social networking came about people would find ways to interact via a BBS - short for Bulletin Board System

engaged in developing Scoop. If it is the profile of the financial backers that makes an impression on the critics and users, then by garnering funds from someone like Schmidt, Scoop has already entered into the big league. Corey Reese, the CEO of Trumpet, has recruited Nick Simmons and Michael Akilian, two inimitable college students to develop Scoop.

Nick Simmons says, "In the world of Facebook and Twitter we still find out about what is happening on campus predominantly through word of mouth. This information should be spread more efficiently and should be at our fingertips. Scoop allows people to talk about this information in real time." Once a



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sufficient number of students are armed with smartphones, which are running this application, then it will become easy to hold a campus wide conversation. Everyone can be updated about formal or informal student events immediately. Scoop is also thought to be quite interactive as compared to other mobile apps. Initially Scoop will be launched as an iPhone application, but down the line the product is expected to become compatible with other popular smartphone models. While talking about the expansion strategy for Scoop, Nick Simmons says, "We would like to launch Scoop at one school initially. Then we want to learn from our mistakes, tweak the service to respond to user feedback, and launch at campuses across the United States and hopefully other countries!"

The expansion strategy that those at the helm of Scoop are envisaging is a lot like the one followed by Facebook

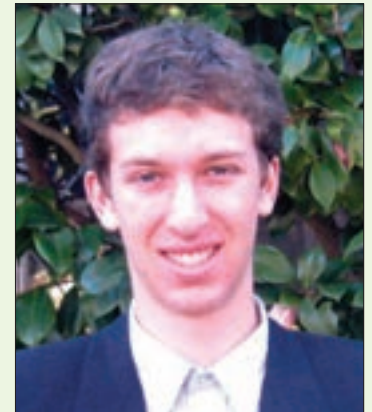
A CHAT WITH NICK SIMMONS, SCOOP

What inspired you to start Scoop?

We've seen several online communities catch on at my school and at my friends' schools. This has made it clear that students want to talk about what's happening on their campus.

What does Scoop stand for? We mean why is the application called Scoop?

When we decided on a name for our product we were not completely finished defining the product—and it will continue to evolve as we receive feedback from users. Therefore, it is imperative to think of a name that accurately describes the scope of the product in a compelling way. The word "scoop" makes me think of a service that provides me with useful information in a fun and social way. At its core that is what we want our service to do.



Right now Scoop seems to be confined to college students. Is there any chance that in future it will become a global phenomenon like Facebook?

We are focused on designing an exciting product for college students at the moment. But, as I mentioned earlier, Scoop's core goal is to provide users with useful information, about what is going on, in a fun and social way. It is not hard to envision a future in which Scoop provides this service to any group of people, whether college students, high school students, people that live near each other, etc. Scoop is about creating a conversation for a community of people, not necessarily just college students.

How has the education that you have received helped you in developing Scoop?

The most helpful aspect of my education has been the social one, not the academic one. My friends on campus and affiliations with certain groups really helps me to spread the word about Scoop and make sure that the right people are using it.

If a college student in India wants to start a social networking application for mobiles, what advise would you like to give him?

Create a product that is simple and social! Users love simplicity, especially in a new service and, as Facebook has taught us, they love to be social.

during the initial days of its inception. The application is going to be rolled out in many campuses across America and according to the feedback that is forthcoming from students the application will be tweaked and improved. Quintessentially this is going to be another case of students building a service for students. Finally when everything is set in place, the application will become available to the much larger section of humanity living outside the college campuses. The home page of Trumpet Technologies (<http://www.trumpet.io>) carries this interesting slogan, "Stay Hungry, Stay Foolish." As of now the promoters have not explained what this

slogan means, but the company's mission is listed as, "Mobile Local Search."

There is no doubt that as 3G and 4G networks continue to expand across the world, the popularity of smartphones will skyrocket. Mobile apps such as Fountainhop and Scoop must be seen as a harbinger of a future, which is just round the corner. This is a future in which people will be extremely mobile, and yet they will be closely networked with their loved ones through some innovative applications running on their smartphones. But what's most promising is that the primary users of the apps are the ones developing them in the first place! 